JusticeLaw: Database Setup Guide

How to get the shared database and API running on your own machine

1. What you are importing

JusticeLaw_Database.sql creates the **lawCRUDdb** database with all tables, the migration history, 6 case types, 4 attorneys, 5 clients, 7 cases, 11 legal tasks and 10 logins (admin, attorneys and clients). Everything is already linked, so no extra seeding or registering is needed.

2. Prerequisites

- .NET 8 SDK (the project uses EF Core 8.0.32).
- SQL Server with SSMS: LocalDB, Express or Developer all work.
- The latest code from the repo, on the same branch as the author.

3. Steps

1. Get the files: Pull the latest code and save **JusticeLaw_Database.sql** somewhere easy to find.

2. Connect in SSMS: Connect to your own instance, for example `(localdb)\MSSQLLocalDB` or `.\SQLEXPRESS`.

3. Remove any old copy: If a database called **lawCRUDdb** already exists, right-click it, choose Delete and tick "Close existing connections". Otherwise the script fails with "already exists" errors.

4. Run the script: File > Open > File, choose the .sql file and press Execute. When it finishes, refresh Databases. **lawCRUDdb** should show 9 tables.

5. Point the API at it: Open `Backend\JusticeLaw.API\appsettings.json`. The server must match your instance and the database name must be lawCRUDdb (example below). Do not commit this change to the repo.

6. Run the API: Open the solution in Visual Studio (or run `dotnet run` in the API folder). Swagger should open in the browser.

7. Run the front end: Start it as usual. It must call the API on the same port the API runs on (the author's is https://localhost:54082), or update the API URL setting.

8. Test a login: Log in with an account from the table in section 4 and check the dashboard shows data.

Connection string example:

```
Server=(localdb)\MSSQLLocalDB;Database=lawCRUDdb;
Trusted_Connection=True;TrustServerCertificate=True
```

Use `.\SQLEXPRESS` as the server if that is your instance.

4. Test logins

Role	Name	Email	Password
Admin	Administrator	admin@justicelaw.com	Justice@2026
Attorney	Thandi Nkosi	thandi.nkosi@justicelaw.com	Justice@2026
Attorney	Pieter van der Merwe	pieter.vdmerwe@justicelaw.com	Justice@2026
Attorney	Aisha Patel	aisha.patel@justicelaw.com	Justice@2026
Attorney	Lwazi Mokoena	lwazi.mokoena@justicelaw.com	Justice@2026
Client	Sipho Dlamini	sipho.dlamini@gmail.com	@Dlamini199
Client	Nomsa Khumalo	nomsa.khumalo@outlook.com	Justice@2026
Client	Johan Botha	johan.botha@webmail.co.za	Justice@2026
Client	Fatima Moosa	fatima.moosa@gmail.com	Justice@2026
Client	Thabo Mahlangu	thabo.mahlangu@gmail.com	Justice@2026

These are test accounts with made-up data. Sipho's password is different from the rest.

5. Testing in Swagger

- Call `POST /api/Auth/login` with an email and password, then copy the token from the response.
- Click Authorize at the top, paste the token (with `Bearer ` in front if the box does not add it) and close the dialog.
- Call `GET /api/Cases`. Each user should only see their own cases.

Login	Cases they should see
Thandi Nkosi (ATT001)	CASE001, CASE005, CASE007
Pieter van der Merwe (ATT002)	CASE002
Aisha Patel (ATT003)	CASE003
Lwazi Mokoena (ATT004)	CASE004
Sipho Dlamini (CLI001)	CASE001, CASE006
Nomsa Khumalo (CLI002)	CASE002, CASE007
Johan Botha (CLI003)	CASE003
Fatima Moosa (CLI004)	CASE004
Thabo Mahlangu (CLI005)	CASE005

Logging in as a different user replaces the token. Use Authorize > Logout before authorizing again. Only the admin can call the register endpoint, so an attorney's or client's token returns 403 there.

6. Do not

- Run `dotnet ef database update` or `Update-Database` on top of the imported database. The script already contains the migration history.
- Run the old DummyData scripts. The data is already in the database.
- Import into a server that still has an old lawCRUDdb. Delete it first.

7. Troubleshooting

Problem	Likely fix
"Database already exists" errors when running the script	Delete the existing lawCRUDdb and run the script again.
Cannot connect to the database	The server name in the connection string does not match your instance.
401 or invalid login	Wrong password (see section 4) or an expired token. Log in again.
403 on an endpoint	The logged-in role is not allowed on it. Log in as the right user, for example the admin for register.
Front end shows no data	The API is not running, or it is on a different port from the one the front end expects.
Script error about a SQL Server version	Your SQL Server is older than 2019. Ask for a re-export with an older "Script for Server Version".

If you are still stuck, send the exact error message and the line number SSMS points to.